

Some minor irritants include the inability to prevent quoting the previous message in the reply. The need to click on links to add a CC or BCC address and to attach a file could have been done away with by keeping these fields expanded in the first place. It is not possible to open e-mails in the background while one e-mail is being read. Use of the browser's back button is not recommended when using the Standard interface. Using the interface's back button usually refreshes the data, leading to delays when compared with loading from the cache, as occurs when using the browser's back button.

10.4 Differences between the Standard and HTML interface

With the absence of the script, a lot of the functionality is lost in the HTML interface. The casualty list is long: all options including the Settings link, Creating Filter and Labels, are disabled; Instant Messaging is disabled; E-mail IDs are not automatically filled in when composing e-mails; selectively choosing read and unread e-mails is not possible. In fact, you can do little else than read and send e-mails!

Yet, for some, nothing is more pleasing than a stripped down e-mail client. Additionally, some of the irritants of the standard interface can be overcome. Quoting previous e-mails can be disabled, the attach files, CC and BCC links are already expanded, the browser's back button can be used to speed page loading from the cache, and many e-mails can be loaded in the background.

As already mentioned, for those behind a dial-up connection, the HTML interface is recommended.

We'd endorse Gmail *carte blanche*, except for one little—and we mean little—gripe: it is not possible to change the colour scheme!